Empirical Methods for Policy Evaluation

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Shift-Share Instrumental Variables and Models of Firm Dynamics

- Shift-Share Designs
  - $\Rightarrow$ Instrumental variables under heterogenous treatment effects
  - $\Rightarrow$ Shift-share design as leveraging a shift-level natural experiment
  - $\Rightarrow$ Shift-share design as combining difference-in-differences
- Rural migration and urban informality
  - $\Rightarrow$ Imbert and Ulyssea (ECMA, 2026)

Instrumental variables under heterogenous treatment effects

Recap on Instrumental Variables (IV)

- Recall from the intro slides

$$\begin{aligned}\text{ATE} &= \mathbb{E}(Y_i^1 - Y_i^0) \\ &= \mathbb{E}(Y_i^1 \mid D_i = 1) - \mathbb{E}(Y_i^0 \mid D_i = 0) \\ &= \underbrace{\mathbb{E}(Y_i^1 - Y_i^0 \mid D_i = 1)}_{\text{ATT}} + \underbrace{\mathbb{E}(Y_i^0 \mid D_i = 1) - \mathbb{E}(Y_i^0 \mid D_i = 0)}_{\text{Selection bias}}\end{aligned}$$

- A standard solution is to find Z_i such that

$$\mathbb{E}(Y_i^0 \mid Z_i, D_i = 1) = \mathbb{E}(Y_i^0 \mid Z_i, D_i = 0)$$

Potential and Observed Treatments and Outcomes

- Assume binary instrument (offered treatment), $Z_i \in \{0, 1\}$
- Potential treatments are $D_i(z)$ and realized treatment

$$D_i = (1 - Z_i)D_i(0) + Z_i D_i(1)$$

- Potential outcomes are $Y_i(z, d)$ and realized outcomes

$$Y_i = Y_i(Z_i, D_i(Z_i)) = \begin{cases} Y_i(0,0) & \text{if } Z_i = 0, D_i(0) = 0 \\ Y_i(0,1) & \text{if } Z_i = 0, D_i(0) = 1 \\ Y_i(1,0) & \text{if } Z_i = 1, D_i(1) = 0 \\ Y_i(1,1) & \text{if } Z_i = 1, D_i(1) = 1 \end{cases}$$

IV Assumptions

A1 Relevance (first stage)

$$\mathbb{E}[D_i(1)] \neq \mathbb{E}[D_i(0)]$$

A2 Exclusion Restriction (no direct effect of the offered treatment on outcome)

$$Y_i(0,d) = Y_i(1,d) = Y_i(d), \forall d \in \{0,1\}$$

A3 Full Exogeneity (Z_i is exogenous with respect to both the outcome and the treatment)

$$Z_i \perp (D_i(0), D_i(1), Y_i(0), Y_i(1))$$

A4 Monotonicity (Z_i weakly increases incentives to take the treatment)

$$D_i(1) \geq D_i(0), \forall i$$

Local Average Treatment Effects (LATE)

- Under A1-A4 we can identify the ATE for compliers (LATE)

$$\tau^{\text{late}} = \frac{\frac{1}{N}\sum_{i=1}^{N}[Y_i(D_i(1)) - Y_i(D_i(0))]}{\frac{1}{N}\sum_{i=1}^{N}[D_i(1) - D_i(0)]}$$

  $\Rightarrow$ Do not confuse LATE with naive estimand: units who do not comply with offered treat are dropped

$$\tau^{\text{naive}} = \frac{1}{N_c}\sum_{i:D_i(0)=0, D_i(1)=1}[Y_i(1) - Y_i(0)]$$

- Common practice is 2SLS regression of Y_i on D_i using Z_i as the excluded instrument

LATE Example: The Vietnam draft lottery

Table 24.1. ***Summary Statistics for the Angrist Draft Lottery Data***

	Non-Veterans ($N_c = 6{,}675$)				Veterans ($N_t = 2{,}030$)			
	Min	Max	Mean	(S.D.)	Min	Max	Mean	(S.D.)
Draft eligible	0	1	0.24	(0.43)	0	1	0.40	(0.49)
Yearly earnings (in $1,000's)	0	62.8	11.8	(11.5)	0	50.7	11.7	(11.8)
Earnings positive	0	1	0.88	(0.32)	0	1	0.91	(0.29)
Year of birth	50	52	51.1	(0.8)	50	52	50.9	(0.8)

- $\widehat{\tau}^{\text{itt}} = -0.213$ $(\widehat{s.e.} = 0.20)$
- $\widehat{\tau}^{\text{fs}} = 0.1460$ $(\widehat{s.e.} = 0.0108)$
- $\widehat{\tau}^{\text{2sls}} = \frac{\widehat{\tau}^{\text{itt}}}{\widehat{\tau}^{\text{fs}}} = -\frac{0.21}{0.1460} = -1.46$ $(\widehat{s.e.} = 1.36)$

Possible violations of the exclusion restriction

- Never takers: $Y_i(0,0) \neq Y_i(1,0)$

  $\Rightarrow$ Dodging the draft if assigned will likely involve differences in earnings

- Always takers: $Y_i(0,1) \neq Y_i(1,1)$

  $\Rightarrow$ If accepting means different tasks, then possible differences in later earnings

- Compliers and defiers: $Y_i(0,d) \neq Y_i(1,d)$

  $\Rightarrow$ Effect on earnings is attributed to serving in the military and not to the draft itself

Possible violations of the monotonicity assumption

- In the Vietnam draft lottery example
  - $\Rightarrow$ $D_i(1) < D_i(0)$ if some would be willing to volunteer if not drafted but resist to serve if drafted
- The effect of fertility on female labor supply (Z_i is sex composition of siblings)
  - $\Rightarrow$ $D_i(1) \geq D_i(0)$ if all families have same preference for sex mix
  - $\Rightarrow$ $D_i(1) < D_i(0)$ if there are families with stopping rule for two male children
- Judge-leniency design (Z_i randomly assigns judges to cases)
  - $\Rightarrow$ $D_i(1) \geq D_i(0)$ if judge A is stricter than B then A always convicts whenever B would convict
  - $\Rightarrow$ $D_i(1) < D_i(0)$ whenever the two judges disagree

2SLS $\neq$ LATE

- With covariates, 2SLS estimator reflects treatment effects for compliers and always/never-takers
  - $\Rightarrow$ LATE interpretation holds only when controlling for covariates non-parametrically
- If $Z_i \in \{1, .., K\}$ then K compliers' group, one for each subsequent pair of values of Z_i
  - $\Rightarrow$ LATE $= \sum_{k=1}^{K} \omega_k \text{LATE}_k$, where ω_k depend on the instrument
  - $\Rightarrow$ Same intuition for when Z_i is a vector (multiple instruments)
- With unordered, non-cardinal Z_i more assumptions on treatment choice behavior are needed
  - $\Rightarrow$ E.g., Average Monotonicity ($\omega_k \geq 0$, $\forall k$), Unordered Partial Monotonicity

Estimating Target Parameters using a Selection Model

- Consider a threshold crossing model under IV assumptions and covariates X_i

$$D_i = \mathbb{I}(V_i \leq \nu(Z_i, X_i))$$

$\Rightarrow$ V_i is a random variable that captures i's unobserved tendency to take treatment

- Given full exogeneity of Z_i, probability of treatment (propensity score) is

$$P(D_i|Z_i = z, X_i = x) = P(V_i = \nu(z, x)|X_i = x) \equiv F_{V|X}(\nu(z, x)|x) \equiv U_i \sim U[0, 1]$$

$\Rightarrow$ U_i is the quantile of resistance to treatment: $D_i = \mathbb{I}(U_i \leq P(Z_i, X_i))$

Marginal Treatment Effect (MTE)

- The MTE is the ATE among subpopulations with the same propensity to take treatment

$$MTE(u, x) = \mathbb{E}(Y_i(1) - Y_i(0)|U_i = u, X_i = x)$$

- Any target parameter can be written as a weighted average of MTE. E.g:

$$ATE(x) = \int_0^1 MTE(u, x)du$$

$$LATE(x, u', u) = \frac{1}{u' - u} \int_{u'}^{u} MTE(u, x)du$$

$\Rightarrow$ Where $u' = P(D_i(0) = 1)$ and $u = P(D_i(1) = 1)$

MTE Identification

- The derivative of the outcome wrt the propensity score yields the MTE evaluated at $P(Z_i, X_i) = u$

$$MTE(x, p) = \frac{\partial \mathbb{E}(Y_i | X_i = x, P(Z_i, X_i) = p)}{\partial p}$$

  - $\Rightarrow$ At $P_i = p$ those with $u < p$ are treated and those with $u = p$ are indifferent
  - $\Rightarrow$ Marginally increasing p by dp shifts indifferent individuals into treatment
  - $\Rightarrow$ The associated increase in Y_i is $dY = dp \times MTE(x, p)$

- The Local IV estimator is

$$\tau^{\text{liv}} = \frac{\mathbb{E}(Y_i | X_i = x, P(Z_i, X_i) = p(z', x)) - \mathbb{E}(Y_i | X_i = x, P(Z_i, X_i) = p(z, x))}{\mathbb{E}(D_i | X_i = x, Z_i = z') - \mathbb{E}(D_i | X_i = x, Z_i = z)}$$

MTE Identification

- τ^{liv} needs continuous variation in $P_i(Z_i, X_i)$ around u, conditional on $X_i = x$
- Hence, it requires continuous variation in Z_i (combine multiple IVs to extend support of P_i)
- Continuous covariate variation can be used as a substitute if the MTE is assumed to be separable

$$MTE(u, x) = m_X(x) + m_U(u) = X_i(\beta(1) - \beta(0)) + \mathbb{E}(U(1) - U(0)|U = p)$$

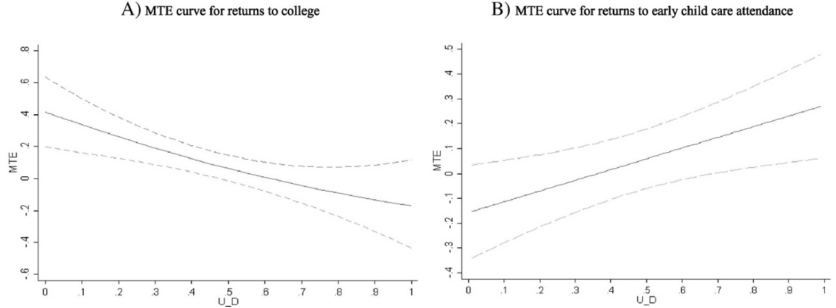
  $\Rightarrow$ X_i affects the intercept of MTE curve but not its slope

  $\Rightarrow$ Identification relies on joint distribution of $P_i(Z_i, X_i)$ rather than conditional $P_i(Z_i|X_i)$

MTE Estimation

- Estimate the propensity score (e.g. Probit or Logit)
- Regress Y on D, X, $D \times X \times \hat{p}$, and a polynomial in $\hat{p}$ of degree k
- Calculate the derivative of Y with respect to $\hat{p}$ at given values of X
- Plot the MTE curve over U and bootstrapped CIs
- Aggregate the MTE over the distribution of covariates with appropriate weights (ATE, ATT, etc.)

MTE Example: The Returns to Education



	(1) Returns to college	(2) Returns to early child care attendance
ATE	0.067* (0.038)	0.059 (0.072)
TT	0.143*** (0.035)	−0.051 (0.080)
TUT	−0.007 (0.071)	0.173** (0.085)
IV	0.095** (0.039)	0.065 (0.133)

Shift-Share Instrumental Variables

- General structure of shift-share IV (SSIV)

$$Z_i = \sum_{k=1}^{K} S_{ik} g_k$$

- $g_1, ..., g_K$ are shifts not specific to i (e.g. industry-level employment growth)
- S_{ik} are exposure shares (e.g. initial share of k in i's employment)
- When $\sum_k S_{ik} = 1 \; \forall i$, Z_i is a (share-)weighted average of the shifts

Shift-Share IV: Decomposition

- $D_i = \frac{X_{i1} - X_{i0}}{X_{i0}}$
- This can be decomposed as $X_{it} = \sum_k X_{ikt}$, hence

$$\frac{X_{i1} - X_{i0}}{X_{i0}} = \sum_k \underbrace{\frac{X_{ik0}}{X_{i0}}}_{\text{Share}} \underbrace{\frac{X_{ik1} - X_{ik0}}{X_{ik0}}}_{\text{Local shift}}$$

- Use a set of common shifts $g_k = \frac{X_{k1} - X_{k0}}{X_{k0}}$ to replace the local shifts

Shift-Share IV: Example 1 (Bartik, 1991)

- Consider the (inverse) regional supply equation:

$$\Delta \log w_i = \tau \underbrace{\Delta \log L_i}_{= \sum_k S_{ik} \Delta \log L_{ik}} + \underbrace{\epsilon_i}_{\text{labor supply shocks}}$$

- Need a regional labor demand shock as IV

- $Z_i = \sum_k S_{ik} g_k$ by replacing $\Delta \log L_{ik}$ with national industry shift g_k
  - $\Rightarrow$ S_{ik} = share of employment in industry k
  - $\Rightarrow$ g_k = observed growth rate of industry employment

Shift-Share IV: Example 2 (Card, 2009)

- Consider the (inverse) elasticity of substitution between native and immigrants

$$\log \frac{w_i^{\text{Immigrant}}}{w_i^{\text{Native}}} = \tau \log \frac{L_i^{\text{Immigrant}}}{L_i^{\text{Native}}} + \underbrace{\epsilon_i}_{\text{change in relative labor demand in region } i}$$

- Need a relative labor supply shock as IV

- $Z_i = \sum_k S_{ik} g_k$: migration prediction from pull & push factors
  - $\Rightarrow$ S_{ik} = initial share of immigrants of origin k in i's population
  - $\Rightarrow$ g_k = observed national migration rate from k, normalized by the stock of migrants from k in the US

The SSIV Exogeneity Challenge

- How should we think about $E[Z_i \epsilon_i] = 0$?
  - $\Rightarrow$ Which properties of the shifts and/or shares can make Z_i exogenous ?
  - $\Rightarrow$ Do we need exogeneity of both shifts and shares, or just one ?
- Two approaches + sets of sufficient conditions
  - $\Rightarrow$ Many exogenous shifts: leveraging a shift-level natural experiment
  - $\Rightarrow$ Exogenous shares: pooling diff-in-diffs based on heterogenous exposure shares

SSIV as leveraging a shift-level natural experiment

Identification: Intuition

- Suppose shifts are as-good-as-random: $\mathbb{E}[g_k \mid \epsilon, S] = \alpha$
- Then $\mathbb{E}(Z_i) = \mathbb{E}[\sum_k S_{ik} g_k \mid \epsilon, S] = \alpha \sum_k S_{ik}$
  - $\Rightarrow$ If shares add up to one, then $\mathbb{E}(Z_i) =$ constant
- A weighted average of as-good-random shifts is as-good-as random
  - $\Rightarrow$ If industries with high/low g_k are comparable, regions specializing in those industries are comparable
  - $\Rightarrow$ True whatever the initial shares are, we don't need Cov $[S_{ik}, \epsilon_i] = 0$
- Translate random variation across k into random variation across i

Identification: Sufficient conditions

- Using the SSIV decomposition

$$\mathbb{E}\left[\sum_i Z_i \epsilon_i\right] = \mathbb{E}\left[\sum_i \sum_k S_{ik} g_k \epsilon_i\right] = \mathbb{E}\left[\sum_k s_k g_k \bar{\epsilon}_k\right]$$

  $\Rightarrow$ Where $s_k = \sum_i S_{ik}$ and $\bar{\epsilon}_k = \sum_i S_{ik}\epsilon_i / \sum_i S_{ik}$ (exposure-weighted averages of residuals)

- $\frac{1}{N}\sum_i Z_i \epsilon_i \to 0$ if

  A1 g_k are uncorrelated with $\bar{\epsilon}_k = \sum_i S_{ik}\epsilon_i / \sum_i S_{ik}$

  A2 The effective number of shifts is large (otw corr $(g_k, \bar{\epsilon}_k) \neq 0$ by chance)

  A3 Shares add up to one for each observation i (otw g_k vary across i through $\sum_k S_{ik}$)

Incomplete Shares

- What if $\sum_k S_{ik} \neq 1$, so Z_i is a weighted sum, not a weighted average?
  - $\Rightarrow$ E.g. lottery that randomly assigns subsidies g_k to manufacturing industries k
- Regions with more manufacturing will mechanically get higher Z_i
- Thus, controlling for $X_i = \sum_k S_{ik}$ avoids bias

Shift-level Controls

- What if shifts are as-good-as-random only after controlling for some q_k?
  - $\Rightarrow$ E.g. industry subsidies are random only controlling for dummy of hi-tech
- $\mathbb{E}(Z_i) = \alpha \sum_k S_{ik}(\alpha_0 + \alpha_1 q_k)$
- To avoid bias, it's sufficient to control for $\sum_k S_{ik}$ and $\sum_k S_{ik} q_k$
- E.g. control for the local share of hi-tech industries
  - $\Rightarrow$ Leverage variation across regions with similar composition of high-tech

Inference

- Observations with similar shares are exposed to same shocks: g_k and (unobserved) ν_k
- Conventional Liang-Zeger clustering (e.g. by state) wouldn't capture that
  - $\Rightarrow$ Placebo shifts $g_k^\star$ generate significant reduced-form effect in $\sim$50% simulations
- If each region was exposed to just one industry, we'd cluster by industry
- But how to do it in a "many-to-one" case?

Shift-level ("Exposure-robust") Standard Errors

- Residualize outcomes and treatment on i-level controls: $V_i^{\perp}$
- Average across observations with weights S_{ik}: $\bar{V}_k^{\perp} = \sum_i S_{ik} V_i^{\perp} / \sum_i S_{ik}$
- SSIV estimate is equal to the estimate from a weighted 2SLS with g_k as IV

$$\bar{Y}_k^{\perp} = \tau \bar{D}_k^{\perp} + \gamma' q_k + \bar{\epsilon}_k$$

  $\Rightarrow$ Where the weights are $s_k = \frac{1}{N} \sum_i S_{ik}$

- Then use robust or clustered SE as in any other regression

Example: The China Shock (Autor, Dorn, Hanson, 2013)

- ADH study the effects of import competition on local labor market outcomes
- Region i = commuting zone (N=722), industry k = SIC4 manufacturing (K=397)
- Two periods t: 1991-2000 and 2000-2007
- Y_{it} = local change in manufacturing employment rate
- D_{it} = local growth of exposure to Chinese imports

$$Z_{it} = \sum_k S^L_{ikt_0} \Delta(\text{Non-US imports from China}_{kt})$$

- Control for period FE and some initial regional characteristics

The China Shock: Balance Tests

- Shifts are uncorrelated with industry Xs, controlling for period FE
- Uncorrelated with regional Xs, controlling for period FExlagged manuf. share

Balance variable	Coef.	SE
Panel A: Industry-level balance		
Production workers' share of employment, 1991	−0.011	(0.012)
Ratio of capital to value-added, 1991	−0.007	(0.019)
Log real wage (2007 USD), 1991	−0.005	(0.022)
Computer investment as share of total, 1990	0.750	(0.465)
High-tech equipment as share of total investment, 1990	0.532	(0.296)
No. of industry-periods	794	
Panel B: Regional balance		
Start-of-period % of college-educated population	0.915	(1.196)
Start-of-period % of foreign-born population	2.920	(0.952)
Start-of-period % of employment among women	−0.159	(0.521)
Start-of-period % of employment in routine occupations	−0.302	(0.272)
Start-of-period average offshorability index of occupations	0.087	(0.075)
Manufacturing employment growth, 1970s	0.543	(0.227)
Manufacturing employment growth, 1980s	0.055	(0.187)
No. of region-periods	1,444	

The China Shock: Estimates/SE from Industry-year Reg.

- China shock is larger in the 2000s (post WTO entry)
- This is when overall manufactaring decline is stronger for other reasons

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)
Coefficient	−0.596	−0.489	−0.267	−0.314	−0.310	−0.290	−0.432
	(0.114)	(0.100)	(0.099)	(0.107)	(0.134)	(0.129)	(0.205)
Regional controls							
Autor *et al.* (2013) controls	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓
Start-of-period mfg. share	✓						
Lagged mfg. share		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Period-specific lagged mfg. share			✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Lagged 10-sector shares					✓		✓
Local Acemoglu *et al.* (2016) controls						✓	
Lagged industry shares							✓
SSIV first stage F-stat.	185.6	166.7	123.6	272.4	64.6	63.3	27.6
No. of region-periods	1,444	1,444	1,444	1,444	1,444	1,444	1,444
No. of industry-periods	796	794	794	794	794	794	794

SSIV as combining diff-in-diffs

Special Case 1: One Time Period, Two Industries

- $S_{i2} = 1 - S_{i1}$
- $Z_i = S_{i1}g_1 + S_{i2}g_2 = S_{i1}g_1 + (1 - S_{i1})g_2 = g_2 + (g_1 - g_2)S_{i1}$
- First Stage

$$D_i = \gamma_0 + \gamma Z_i + \eta_i$$
$$D_i = \underbrace{\gamma_0 + \gamma g_2}_{\text{constant}} + \underbrace{\gamma(g_1 - g_2)}_{\text{coefficient}} S_{i1} + \eta_i$$

- The instrument is S_{i1}, while g_k affects relevance

Special Case 2: T Periods, Two Industries

- $Z_{it} = S_{i10} g_{1t} + S_{i20} g_{2t} = g_{2t} + (\Delta_{gt}) S_{i10}$
- First Stage

$$D_i = \tau_i + \tau_t + \gamma Z_{it} + \eta_{it}$$
$$D_i = \tau_i + \underbrace{\tau_t + \gamma g_{2t}}_{\tilde{\tau}_t} + \underbrace{\gamma \Delta_{gt}}_{\tilde{\gamma}_t} S_{i10} + \eta_{it}$$

- Industry shares $\times$ time period is the instrument: $Z_{it} = \underbrace{\Delta_{gt}}_{\text{size}} \underbrace{S_{i10}}_{\text{exposure}}$
- Analogy to continuous diff-in-diff: use "pre-period" to test // pre-trends

General Case; Pooling Diff-in-Diffs

- Assume exogenous shares: Cov $[\epsilon_i, S_{ik}] = 0$ for every k
- With Y_i measured in differences, this is K parallel trend assumptions
- Shares are measured in the pre-period
- Rules out any unobserved shocks ν_k that affect Y_i via S_{ik} (or similar shares)
  - $\Rightarrow$ Even if shares are drawn at random, these shocks would violate // trends
- Then we have K valid IVs: $S_{i1}, ..., S_{iK}$
  - $\Rightarrow$ SSIV with $Z_i = \sum_k S_{ik} g_k$ is one reasonable way to combine them
  - $\Rightarrow$ 2SLS (for small K, or even one k) is another alternative

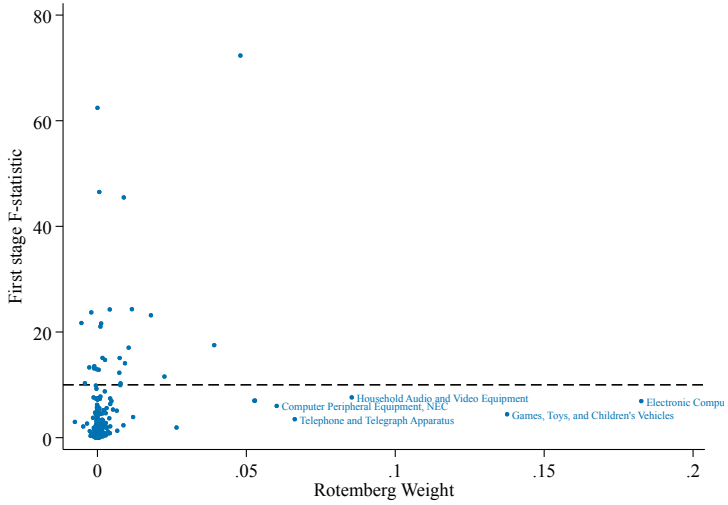
Plausible Vs. Implausible Exogenous Shares

- Construct the instrument with shares that are tailored to the treatment
- Mediating only the shocks to D_{it} and not other shocks that might affect Y_{it}. E.g.:
  - $\Rightarrow$ Immigration shares: local migration from various origins in the past
  - $\Rightarrow$ Industry employment shares are generic: reflect exposure to other shocks
- Same instrument for different treatments, i.e. "Blunt IV" $\rightarrow$ problematic

Which shares matter the most for the estimates?

- $\hat{\beta}_{IV} = \sum_k \hat{\alpha}_k \hat{\beta}_k$ for $\hat{\tau}_k$ that uses S_{ik} as IV one at a time $\rightarrow \beta$ is over-identified
- $\hat{\alpha}_k$ are higher for k with more extreme shifts and/or larger first stages (Rotemberg weights)
- $\hat{\alpha}_k$ add up to one but can be negative $\rightarrow$ potential issue with heterogenous treat. effects
  - $\Rightarrow$ When shares add up to one, use demeaned shifts
- Sensitivity of the SSIV estimate to violations of exogeneity by each S_{ik} as IV
  - $\Rightarrow$ Scrutinize how estimates change when using only the share IVs with high weights

China Shock Example (continued): Rotemberg Weights



Summary of Main Practical Takeaways

	Approach	
	Many exogenous shifts (1)	**Exogenous shares** (2)
Identification argument	Shifts are as-good-as-randomly assigned and only affect the outcome through the treatment	Each share satisfies parallel trends: the outcomes of units with high vs. low shares would have trended the same if not for the treatment
Estimation	Control for the sum of shares (if not one) and shift-share aggregates of any shift-level controls	Check robustness to using share instruments directly: e.g., one share at a time or pooled via two-stage least squares or limited information maximum likelihood
Statistical inference	Get exposure-robust standard errors from the equivalent shift-level instrumental variable regression	Use conventional heteroskedasticity- or cluster-robust standard errors
Balance tests	For both the shift-share instrument and the shifts	For both the shift-share instrument and the shares with high Rotemberg weights
Do not use when...	You would not want to use the shifts directly as an instrument in a shift-level regression, e.g. because they are too few or endogenous	You would not want to use shares directly as instruments, e.g. because they are "generic" (capturing the unit's exposure to many types of shocks)

Rural migration and Urban Informality: Evidence from Brazil

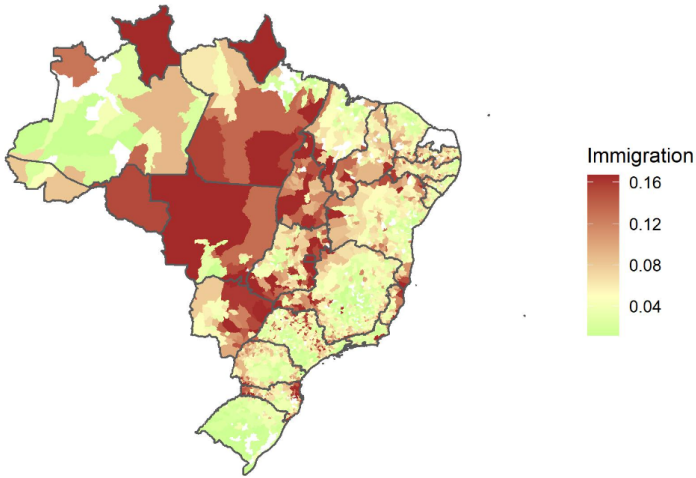
Imbert and Ulyssea (ECMA, 2026)

- Study the labor market effects of rural-urban migration across regions in Brazil
- SSIV to identify the medium-run effect of immigration on labor markets at destination
  - $\Rightarrow$ $\uparrow$ formal employment, $\downarrow$ informal employment, and $\downarrow$ formal wages
  - $\Rightarrow$ $\uparrow$ formal firms, $\uparrow$ jobs, $\uparrow$ entry, and $\uparrow$ exit
- Model of firms dynamics with informality and heterogenous growth profiles across firms
  - $\Rightarrow$ Equilibrium effect of immigration with/without downward wage rigidity
  - $\Rightarrow$ Informal sector partly absorbs extra labor supply and acts as stepping stone to formality

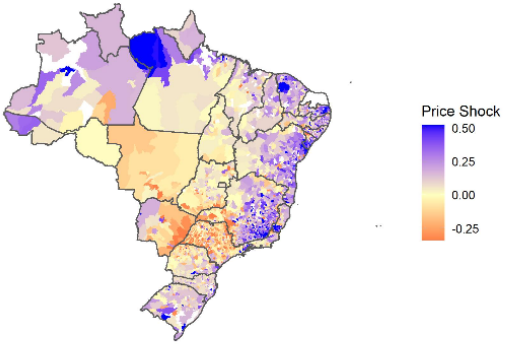
Data

- Migration and Labor Market Outcomes: Population Census, 1991-2010
  - $\Rightarrow$ Migrants = in their current location $\leq$ 10 years
  - $\Rightarrow$ Focus migration to urban areas (88%), and cross-state borders
- Firm-level data
  - $\Rightarrow$ Matched employer-employee, universe of formal firms and workers
  - $\Rightarrow$ Survey data on small (up to 5 employees) formal and informal firms
- Migration "Push" shocks
  - $\Rightarrow$ International agricoltural commodity price shocks $\times$ crop shares at the muni. level (in 1980)
  - $\Rightarrow$ Drought index $\times$ growing season by crop $\times$ crop shares

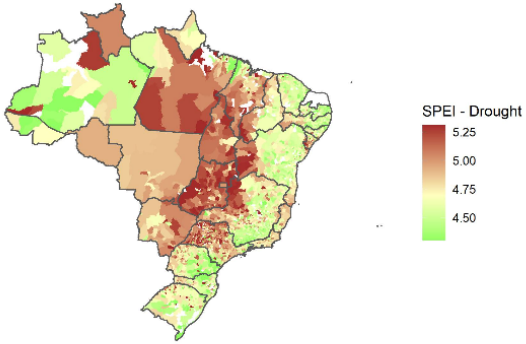
Immigration, 2000-2010



Migration Push Shocks



(a) Price Shocks



(b) Drought Shocks

Shift-Share Design

$$\Delta y_d = \beta_0 + \beta_1 Mig_d + \beta_2' X_d + u_d$$

- $\Delta y_d = y_{d,2010} - y_{d,2000}$
- $Mig_d = \sum_o \sum_{t=2001}^{2010} \frac{Mig_{o,d,t}}{Pop_{d,2000}}$
- X_d: share of male, young, and high skill (HS completed) in 2000
- Instrument: $Z_d = \sum_o \underbrace{\lambda_{o,d}}_{\text{shares}} \underbrace{s_o^{\text{drought}}}_{\text{shift}}$

Shift-Share Design: Identification

- Baseline immigration shares (the pull factor) may be endogenous to labor market outcomes
- Push-shocks (shifts) are as good as randomly assigned
- Instrument only affects the dependent variables via the current immigration shares
- A few specification/robustness checks
  - $\Rightarrow$ Pre-trends: dynamic effects + lagged changes in outcomes as a control
  - $\Rightarrow$ Persistence of migration: control for lagged migration rates
  - $\Rightarrow$ Capital channel: control for exposure through bank network
  - $\Rightarrow$ Demand channel: control for local price shocks and shocks to neighboring regions
  - $\Rightarrow$ Second push instrument coming from variations in international crop prices

Effects of Immigration on Workers

	Wage employment			Log monthly wage		
	Overall (1)	Formal (2)	Informal (3)	Overall (4)	Formal (5)	Informal (6)
Panel A: OLS						
Immigration	0.037*	0.105***	−0.068***	0.062	0.032	0.035
	(0.019)	(0.023)	(0.014)	(0.076)	(0.068)	(0.092)
Panel B: IV-Drought						
Immigration	−0.014	0.271***	−0.284***	−0.126	−0.671**	−0.200
	(0.060)	(0.089)	(0.072)	(0.284)	(0.336)	(0.352)
F Statistic (IV)	18.11	18.11	18.11	18.11	18.11	18.11
Baseline Mean	0.332	0.229	0.103	-	-	-
Observations	3,545	3,545	3,545	3,545	3,545	3,545

Notes: Robust standard errors in parenthesis. All regressions control for the share of women, youth (less than 18 years old), and high skill individuals (at least completed high-school) measured in 2000. All regressions are weighted by municipality's population in 2000.

Effects of Immigration on Firms

	Nb firms (1)	Entry (2)	Exit (3)	Nb jobs (4)	Firm wage (5)
Panel A: OLS					
Immigration	1.342***	1.167***	1.588***	1.071***	0.372***
	(0.108)	(0.203)	(0.274)	(0.270)	(0.101)
Panel B: IV-Drought					
Immigration	1.625***	2.555***	2.758**	2.031***	−0.747
	(0.306)	(0.877)	(1.123)	(0.624)	(0.554)
F Statistic (IV)	18.11	18.11	18.11	18.11	18.11
Observations	3,545	3,545	3,545	3,545	3,545

Notes: Robust standard errors in parenthesis. All regressions control for the share of women, youth (less than 18 years old), and high skill individuals (at least completed high-school) measured in 2000. All regressions are weighted by municipality's population in 2000. Columns 1-3 refer to the log of total number of firms, entrants and exiting firms, respectively.

Shift-Share Design: Summary of Results

- 1p.p. increase in $Mig_d(18.5\%SD)$
  - $\Rightarrow$ Increase formal employment 0.27 p.p. $\approx$ 1.2% increase
  - $\Rightarrow$ Decrease formal wages by 0.7%; no effect on informal wages
  - $\Rightarrow$ Increase number of firms by 1.6%, and number of formal jobs by 2%
  - $\Rightarrow$ There is greater churn: effect on both entry and exit are large
- Downward wage rigidity is more likely to hold in the short than in the long run
  - $\Rightarrow$ With inflation, real wages in the formal sector can adjust downward so formal employment increases

Model: Overview

- Continuum of firms indexed by their individual productivity θ
- Same technology, labor only input: $f(\ell) = \theta q(\ell), q' > 0, q'' < 0$
- Tradeoffs are driven by regulations and enforcement
  - $\Rightarrow$ Informal firms: lower entry costs, but cost of operation is increasing in firm size
  - $\Rightarrow$ Formal firms: face regulatory costs (but can evade), and constant marginal costs
- Endogenous exit + exogenous death shock (different across sectors)

Firm Profits

- Informal firms avoid taxes but pay an informality cost

$$\Pi_i(\theta, w) = \max_{\ell}\{\theta q(\ell) - \tau_i(\ell)w\}, \quad \tau_i' > 0, \tau_i'' > 0$$

- Formal firms pay revenue taxes but can evade payroll tax

$$\Pi_f(\theta, w) = \max_{\ell}\{(1-\tau_y)\theta q(l) - C(\ell)\}$$

$$C(l) = \begin{cases} \tau_f(\ell)w & \text{for } \ell \leq \tilde{\ell} \\ \tau_f(\tilde{\ell})w + (1+\tau_w)(\ell - \tilde{\ell}) & \text{for } \ell > \tilde{\ell}, \end{cases}$$

- Where $\tau_f' > 0, \tau_f'' > 0$ and $\tilde{\ell}$ such that $\tau_f'(\tilde{\ell}) = 1 + \tau_w$

Firm Dynamics

- Dynamics is driven by the evolution of firms' idiosyncratic productivity θ
- Productivity process is given by

$$\begin{aligned}\ln \theta_{j,1} &= \ln \nu_j + \ln \epsilon_{j,1} \\ \ln \theta_{j,t} &= \rho_s \ln \theta_{j,t-1} + (1-\rho_s) \ln \nu_j + \ln \epsilon_{j,t}, \quad t \geq 2\end{aligned}$$

- Where j indexes firms, $s \in \{i, f\}$ denotes sector, and $\ln \epsilon \sim \ln N(0, \sigma_s^2)$
- Formal firms cannot become informal
- Informal firms can pay $\tilde{c}^e = c_f^e - c_i^e$ and formalize

Firm Dynamics (continued)

- The value functions of formal and informal incumbent firms

$$
\begin{aligned}
V_f(\theta, w) =& \pi_f(\theta, w) + (1-\delta_f)\beta \max\{0, E_\nu[V_f(\theta', w) \mid \theta]\} \\
V_i(\theta, w) =& \pi_i(\theta, w) \\
&+\beta \max\{0, (1-\delta_i)E_\nu[V_i(\theta', w) \mid \theta], (i-\delta_f)E_\nu[V_f(\theta', w) \mid \theta] - \tilde{c}^e\}
\end{aligned}
$$

- where β is the discount factor, δ_s the exogenous exit

- Exit decisions and informal-to-formal transitions follow cutoff rules

$$
\begin{aligned}
E_\nu[V_s(\theta', w) \mid \underline{\theta}_s] &= 0, \quad s \in \{i, f\} \\
E_\nu[V_f(\theta', w) - V_i(\theta', w) \mid \overline{\theta}_i] &= \tilde{c}^e
\end{aligned}
$$

Firm Entry

- Entrants in both sectors pay a fixed cost of entry, denoted by $c_s^e, s \in \{i, f\}$
- These parameters will be estimated, but theory suggests that $c_f^e > c_i^e$
- Expected value of entry for firm with long-run productivity ν: $E[V_s(\theta, w) \mid \nu]$
- Entry is also characterized by cutoff rules

$$E_\nu[V_i(\theta, w) \mid \underline{\nu}_i] = c_i^e$$
$$E_\nu[V_f(\theta, w) - V_i(\theta, w) \mid \underline{\nu}_f] = c_f^e - c_i^e$$

- Where $\underline{\nu}_s$ characterizes the last firm to enter sector $s = i, f$

Empirical Predictions

- Immigration shock: ↑ both labor supply and demand for the final good
- Lower real wages and higher labor demand for incumbent firms
- Incumbents are limited by scale, so ↑ in labor supply → greater firm entry
- In equilibrium not only effect on entry rates but also exit rates and firm size distribution
- Net effect on informality, or output per worker, is unclear
  - ⇒ If migrants are absorbed by informal firms and/or low-productivity formal firms: ↑ informality
  - ⇒ if lower wages induce more entry then more firm growth in the formal sector and lower informality

Model Parametrization

- Production function: $y(\theta, \ell) = \theta \ell^{\alpha}, \quad 0 < \alpha < 1$
- Cost functions: $\tau_s(\ell) = \left(1 + \frac{\ell}{\varphi_s}\right) \ell, \quad \varphi_s > 0$

$\Rightarrow$ The larger φ_i the more informal firms can grow, the larger φ_f the easier for formal firms to hire informal workers

- Long-run productivity $\nu \sim H$, observed before entry occurs

$$H(\nu \geq x) = \begin{cases} \left(\frac{\nu_0}{x}\right)^{\xi} & \text{for } x \geq \nu_0 \\ 1 & \text{for } x < \nu_0 \end{cases}$$

$\Rightarrow$ First productivity draw $\theta_1 = \nu \epsilon_1$ has a Pareto-Lognormal distribution

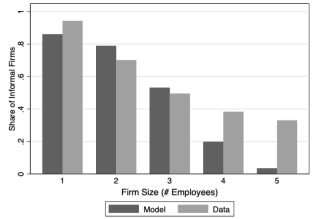
Estimation

- Two step SMM procedure (set τ_w, τ_y to statutory values)
  - $\Rightarrow$ First step: system GMM and panel data on productivity process ρ_f
  - $\Rightarrow$ Second step: 12 remaining parameter estimated using SMM
- Moments
  - $\Rightarrow$ Overall share of informal firms and by size brackets
  - $\Rightarrow$ Average share of informal workers within formal firms
  - $\Rightarrow$ Formal and informal firm growth at ages 5 and 10 relative to age 1
  - $\Rightarrow$ Formal/informal firms size distribution by size brackets

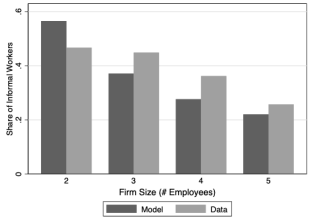
Model's parameters

Parameter	Description	Source	Value
First Step			
τ_w	Payroll Tax	Statutory values	0.375
τ_y	Revenue Tax	Statutory values	0.293
ρ	Productivity Process: Persistence Parameter	GMM Estimation	0.92
ν_0	Pareto's Location Parameter	Calibrated	7.3
γ_f	Per-period fixed cost (Formal)	Calibrated	0.7
Second Step: Min. Dist. Calibration			
φ_f	Intensive margin: $\tau_f = \left(1 + \frac{\ell}{\varphi_f}\right)\ell$	–	5.830
φ_i	Extensive margin: $\tau_i = \left(1 + \frac{\ell}{\varphi_i}\right)\ell$	–	5.427
δ_i	Informal death shock	–	0.148
δ_f	Formal death shock	–	0.066
γ_i	Per-period fixed cost (Informal)	–	0.340
ξ	Pareto shape parameter	–	3.801
$c_f^{e\,\dagger}$	Formal sector's entry cost	–	6,205
$c_i^{e\,\dagger}$	Informal sector's entry cost	–	2,800
α	Span-of-control	–	0.643
σ_i	Informal productivity process: SD	–	0.144
σ_f	Formal productivity process: SD	–	0.145
ρ_i	Informal productivity process: persistence	–	0.935

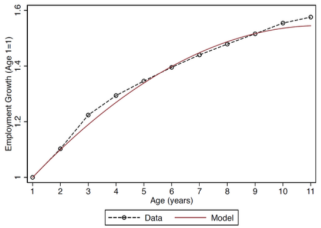
Model Fit: Non-targeted Moments



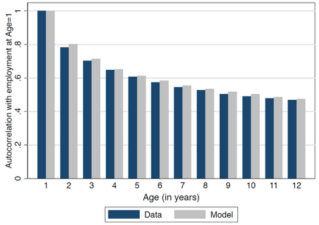
(a) Extensive Mg.



(b) Intensive Mg.



(c) Formal Firms' growth



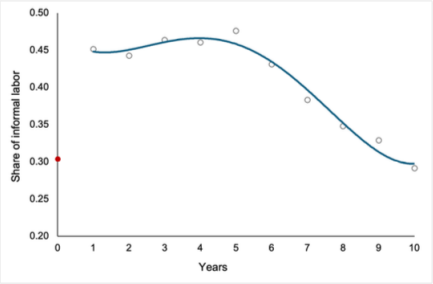
(d) Log-Employment Autocorrelations

Counterfactuals

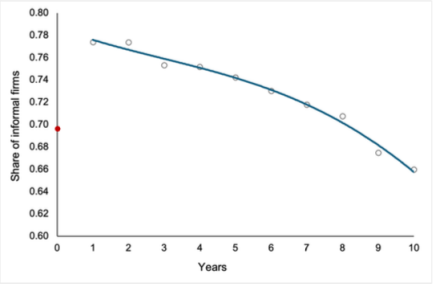
	IV Estimation	Labor Supply Shock	LS Shock + Enforcement
Share Informal Workers (Δ%)	-7.3	-4.3	-38.2
Wages (Δ%)	-5.3	-3.4	-2.1
Number Formal Firms (Δ%)	20.7	16.3	128
Newly created firms	–	9.9	–
Previously informal firms	–	6.4	–
Share Informal Firms (Δ%)	–	-5.3	-68.2
Average Firm Productivity (Δ%)	–	-1.4	2.5
Output (Δ%)	–	7.1	8.3
Taxes (Δ%)	–	8.7	30.9

Notes: IV estimation results from a regression contrasting municipalities below and above the median immigration rate (see text). Labor supply shock corresponds to simulating a permanent increase of 10% in population, and effects are measured as percentage change relative to baseline values.

From Short- to Long-Run: Wage Rigidity in the Formal Sector



(a) Labor Informality



(b) Firm Informality

Notes: Red dot indicates the initial steady state of the baseline economy.

Main Takeways from the Estimated Model

- Model revisits empirical evidence on the LMK effect of (internal) immigration
- $\downarrow$ wages, $\uparrow$ entry of formal firms, nb of formal firms, jobs and formal. share

$\Rightarrow$ Gains do not accrue to the most productive firms $\rightarrow$ output per worker falls

$\Rightarrow$ Despite its role as a "stepping-stone" in the short run, the informal sector reduces the aggregate benefits of immigration

$\Rightarrow$ The typical Harris-Todaro-Fields result arises with downward wage rigidity in the formal sector: higher informality + lower output gains

SSIV $\Leftrightarrow$ Economic Model

- Model attempts to rationalize surprising results from SSIV
- The model quantitatively replicates the long-run IV results
- Model sheds light on mechanism for $\uparrow$ in formal firms (40% comes from the formalization of informal firms, and 60% comes from the creation of new formal firms)

$\Rightarrow$ Firm dynamics and the linkages between the informal and formal sectors